

BRANDDON COELHO

Chief Digital Officer

Application Architect

Senior Software Engineer

 <https://branndon.dev/linkedin>  <https://github.com/BranndonWork>  <https://branndon.dev/>  resume@branndon.dev

ABOUT BRANDDON

- Seasoned software engineer with over **15 years** of professional experience in full-stack development and team leadership. Led technical initiatives at The Penny Hoarder from startup to recognized media platform, orchestrating critical business applications, optimizing site performance from **2.7 seconds to 0.89**, designing a **machine learning-based** email content recommendation system, and building a production Single Page Application job portal with **Node.js WebSocket backend** and automated testing. Contributed to transforming the company from **\$4 million to \$40 million** in annual revenue while scaling technical teams from 10 to over 100 employees.

Currently at **Headspace**, specializing in **Django**-based application development with focus on **scalable and security-focused** software architecture. Responsibilities include mentoring junior engineers, guiding software architecture decisions, and ensuring adherence to industry best practices while staying current with Django framework enhancements.

As **Chief Digital Officer** at **SpecialNeeds.com**, architect production **LLM systems** with **Langchain** connectors for automated content research, summarization, and standardization. Built scalable infrastructure supporting **Django backend** with **Next.js frontend** and custom API endpoints for content generation.

Brandon's top 5 professional strengths in order are:

- [Strategic - naturally spots patterns and alternative pathways to solutions](#)
- [Activator - naturally takes initiative and makes things happen quickly](#)
- [Individualization - notices unique qualities and tailors approach accordingly](#)
- [Achiever - driven by constant accomplishment and works with stamina](#)
- [Adaptability - able to switch gears quickly when priorities change](#)

Source: Gallup/Clifton Strengths Finder <https://www.gallup.com/cliftonstrengths/en/252137/home.aspx>

WORK EXPERIENCE

Work experience dating back to 2007: <https://branndon.dev/linkedin>

- Chief Digital Officer - [SpecialNeeds.com](#)**

2023 - Present

Architected and built comprehensive special needs resource platform. Developed **Django backend** with **Next.js frontend** utilizing Cloudflare Workers for caching and R2 for asset management. Created **LLM-powered** content generation system using **Langchain** connectors for automated content research, summarization, and standardization.

Designed and implemented virtual author system leveraging multiple **LLM providers** for content creation, **data ETL** processes for resource standardization, and custom API endpoints for summary generation and content research. Built scalable infrastructure supporting directory listings, messaging features, and community engagement tools.

Architected production **LLM applications** including content generation workflows, automated data processing pipelines, and image generation systems. Integrated AI capabilities throughout the platform to automate content management processes.

Achievements:

- Built production **LLM application** serving special needs community with **Django backend**, **Next.js frontend**, and Cloudflare Workers infrastructure
- Developed virtual author system using **Langchain connectors** for automated content generation and research
- Implemented **data ETL pipelines** with LLM-powered standardization for resource directory management
- Created custom API endpoints for summary generation, content research, and image generation using multiple LLM providers

○ Senior Software Engineer - [Headspace](#)

2022 - Present

Lead development of **Django-based applications** and major platform initiatives including **Server-Driven UI** project, where I transitioned from Python to **TypeScript** to enhance existing **Node.js** Hapi API system with server-driven UI capabilities, converting all mobile app display logic to server-side control. Led the onboarding flow team while ensuring **GDPR compliance** throughout the project lifecycle.

Supported Headspace-Ginger platform merger project integration combining Headspace meditation app with Ginger's coaching and clinical therapy services. Extended platform to allow teenagers access to coaching services with guardian consent mechanisms. Built guardian consent workflows and led SMS architecture migration using **Braze API integration**, eliminating dual-source synchronization issues.

Contributed to therapy intake form redesign project, breaking apart large therapy and psychiatry intake forms into streamlined onboarding and comprehensive therapy intake components. Worked on Gatsby-based YAML forms with card-driven screen architecture guided by Figma designs, and developed **Django backend** systems for form processing, SMS consent subscriptions, policy agreements, and user profile database updates.

Lead technical decisions while mentoring engineers in **Django** best practices and system architecture. Design **RESTful APIs** for complex environments while promoting code quality and performance optimization across cross-functional teams. Implemented **GDPR compliance** workflows and data anonymization for DSAR requests while integrating AI development tools (Claude Code, ChatGPT, Cursor) into team workflows and development processes.

Achievements:

- Led team for onboarding flow conversion in company-wide **Server-Driven UI** initiative, enhancing **Node.js** Hapi API system with **TypeScript** SDUI capabilities while ensuring **GDPR compliance**
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to integrate coaching and clinical therapy services into Headspace platform post-acquisition
- Project lead for SMS consent architecture migration from dual-source to single-source using **Braze API integration**, eliminating synchronization issues and improving system reliability
- Implemented proper data anonymization workflows for **DSAR account deletion compliance**
- Extended platform capabilities for Ginger For Teens project, developing guardian consent mechanisms and age-appropriate access controls for teen coaching services

○ Senior Software Engineer - [Webley Systems](#)

2020 - 2021

Spearheaded the development of a real-time screen capture system similar to Loom, architecting backend infrastructure to receive video chunks every 10 seconds, store them in AWS S3, and combine them for seamless playback. Built scalable video processing pipeline generating HLS playlists (m3u8) for real-time video delivery. Employed Flask for RESTful API development and utilized Python's advanced features like decorators and context managers while interfacing with React frontend.

Achievements:

- Achieved proficiency in Flask and embraced TDD principles through dedicated training sessions.
- Engineered a custom automation system reminiscent of GIT, revolutionizing a two-decade-old manual ticketing process. This innovative tool bridged updates between the legacy CMS and Slack channels via headless Selenium, demonstrating a blend of autonomy and technical acumen.

- Engineered real-time video processing system handling fragmented video segments, automatically generating HLS streaming playlists for immediate playback. Autonomously designed distributed API infrastructure leveraging AWS Lambda, API Gateway, and ALB to manage concurrent video uploads and real-time segment processing.

○ Application Architect / Lead Developer / Senior Developer - [The Penny Hoarder](#)

2014 - 2020

Joined The Penny Hoarder as **founding engineer** in 2014 through a consulting agency, transitioning to a full-time role in Florida by 2015.

Played a key role in the evolution of the IT department, starting as its sole member and subsequently contributing to the hiring of roles including IT Director, Lead Developer, DevOps Engineer, QA Lead, and Scrum Master.

Built comprehensive WFH Jobs Portal **SPA** using **Node.js WebSocket backend** for real-time updates, custom **WordPress API** integration, and **Protractor/Selenium** automated testing suite. Implemented advanced search filtering, dynamic routing with HTML5 History API, and multi-dimensional job categorization.

Drove the design and deployment of critical business applications including real-time dashboards showing live site metrics, administrative interfaces, and automated reporting systems. Implemented **Redis pub/sub** architecture for real-time data updates, intelligent caching strategies with configurable TTL, and **Amazon SQS** queues for background job processing. Architected multi-system integration connecting **Redshift data warehouse** to **AWS Lambda-based ML processing pipeline**.

Contributed to team growth by leading weekly code reviews, mentoring developers, and collaborating with both executive staff and project management to align technical and business goals.

Achievements:

- **Application Architect**
 - Architected and built production **Single Page Application** job search portal with **Node.js WebSocket backend**, real-time search filtering, and comprehensive automated testing suite using **Protractor/Selenium**
 - Optimized site load time from **2.7 seconds to 0.89 seconds**, resulting in significant cost savings and revenue increase
 - Designed and built **machine learning-based** email content recommendation system integrating **Redshift analytics**, **AWS Lambda** processing, and Iterable email platform for personalized content delivery at scale using **Redis caching** and pub/sub architecture
 - Contributed to company growth from **\$4M to \$40M** annual revenue while scaling technical team from **10 to 100+ employees**
- **Lead Developer**
 - Contributed to the recognition of The Penny Hoarder by **Inc. 500 in 2016 and 2017** as a rapidly growing private media company
 - Oversaw a significant site performance initiative, transitioning from AWS Cloudfront to **Cloudflare**, enhancing the site's scalability under heavy loads
- **Senior Developer**
 - Implemented a robust and scalable **WordPress** setup with a focus on performance and maintainability
 - Collaborated closely with the CEO during a comprehensive site migration to **Amazon Web Services**

Professional recommendations continue on the following page

RECOMMENDATIONS

Additional recommendations: <https://branndon.dev/linkedin>

○ Kyle Taylor

CEO | The Penny Hoarder

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/kylebradleytaylor>

I've been lucky enough to work alongside Brandon for nearly two years now and while he's always been a pleasure to work with, I feel like this year in particular has brought about a huge transformation. He has a growing confidence in his skills and abilities and it's been such a pleasure to watch him realize his own talent.

○ Stephen McDermott

IT Director | The Penny Hoarder

<https://linkedin.com/in/stephenmcdermott>

The code looks to be easily maintainable and modular. I have noticed that when creating deliverables, regression testing is relatively isolated. A poorly coded site would include multiple cross dependencies, whereas one change would result in changes across the whole system. Brandon has coded a good portion of this site and it is built well.

○ Jennifer Franko

Scrum Master II | The Penny Hoarder

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/jenniferfranko>

Brandon is one of the most well rounded, patient and talented developers I have had the pleasure to work with. Brandon is always thinking of the user experience as he works on his outstanding coding. Brandon never shows signs of stress and was always able to successfully complete any tasks with favorable results despite deadline pressure. His technical skill is outstanding but he also has the ability to communicate clearly and to collaborate effectively.

Brandon is a rare find within the development world as he is constantly furthering his knowledge and skills. He repetitively amazed me with his industry insight and original approaches to solving problems.

Brandon always takes the time to provide technical guidance and mentorship to his fellow developers. Brandon leads by example and people find his enthusiasm and dedication both inspiring and motivating.

Brandon is dedicated, self-motivated, methodical, and very capable. I thoroughly enjoyed working with him at The Penny Hoarder and hope that one day I will have the privilege to work with him again. He is a true Rock Star!!!

FUN FACTS

Built a Custom 4x4

Being a self-learner, I rebuilt an entire 4x4 truck. This project involved a complete teardown and rebuild of the engine, transmission, transfer cases, paint stripping, repainting and axles. I accomplished this without formal training, using only the early internet as my guide.

Lived in an RV for 3 years

My family and I lived in an RV for three years, traveling across the country while I worked in web development to pay the bills. This phase ended in 2015 when Kyle Taylor of The Penny Hoarder offered to relocate my family to St. Petersburg, FL, where I took on the role of Sr. Developer in-house.

Created my own Job

During meetings with a recent web client, I heard them mention the lack of on-site IT support; instead, they relied on a local vendor. As I was looking for an in-house position, I drafted a proposal highlighting the need for a web developer and the benefits of hiring me. Shortly after, they appointed me as the IT Manager. My responsibilities included onboarding new clients, creating EDI and FTP systems to exchange data with clients, and integrating legacy systems with newer PHP-based systems.